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Hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions

Abstract

Systems, methods, and computer-readable media for hybrid media distribution in a telehealth session are disclosed. A telehealth session may comprise a video conferencing session between local participants in a first location, such as an operating room, and remote participants in a second location distinct from the first location. The remote participants may connect to the telehealth session via a remote server. The local participants may connect to the telehealth session via a local server disposed in the first location. The local server may forward data received from devices in the first location to the remote server. Prior to forwarding the data, the local server may obscure portions of the data to protect the privacy of the data, such as the face of a patient. The remote server may then broadcast the obscured data to the remote participants.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This non-provisional patent application is a continuation-in-part and claims prior benefit, with regard to all common subject matter, of earlier-filed U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/207,343 (“the '343 Application”), filed Jun. 8, 2023, and entitled “HYBRID MEDIA DISTRIBUTION FOR TELEHEALTH SESSIONS”. The '343 application claims priority to earlier-filed U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/440,539, filed Jan. 23, 2023, and entitled “HYBRID MEDIA DISTRIBUTION FOR TELEHEALTH SESSIONS”. The identified '343 non-provisional patent application and '539 provisional patent application are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties into the present application.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to telehealth. More specifically, embodiments of the present disclosure relate to hybrid media distribution using both a local server located in an operating room and cloud-based servers to facilitate a telehealth session.

2. Related Art

(2) Telehealth involves the remote practice of medicine such that a medical practitioner can communicate with a patient when the medical practitioner and the patient are not in the same location. Telehealth is often carried out using video conference techniques, such as a WebRTC video conference. Telehealth technology can enable a medical practitioner, such as a surgeon, to remotely participate in a medical operation. For example, a patient may need a complex brain surgery performed. An expert on the brain surgery may be located in a separate country from where the surgery is taking place. Using telesurgery techniques, the remote expert can video conference into the surgery while the surgery is taking place and provide assistance to the surgeon performing the surgery.

(3) When performing a telesurgery, cameras capture video of the operation being performed and stream the video as part of the video conference. It is generally desirable to use wireless cameras to reduce the trip hazard associated with wired devices in the operating room and the need to sanitize the wiring. Accordingly, wireless and IP cameras that stream video data directly to a hosting server for the telehealth session are often used. However, WebRTC clients cannot detect the wireless cameras as native during a video conferencing session in order to enable a localized preview of the session before the data is broadcast to other participants. Enabling a localized preview allows for the data to be manipulated before being sent to video conference participants, which may be important in telehealth applications when the patient's privacy must be protected. Thus, if a localized preview of the video data is not provided, the data cannot be manipulated (i.e., obscured) before the data leaves the operating room.

(4) Further, it is often desirable to create a recording of the telehealth surgery for later playback. For example, the recording may be useful for later use as a lecture tool to medical students. However, quality of the media is often lost when transmitting the media data from the in-operating room devices to the cloud server due to bandwidth restrictions. Additionally, if connection to the server is lost and/or the server otherwise fails, the information captured during the downtime will be lost in the recording. The relative latency between devices participating in the telehealth session that are located in distinct physical locations poses difficulties in synchronizing the recording to the point of data capture for each device. What is needed are improved techniques for generating high quality recordings of telehealth sessions. Further, what is needed are telehealth systems that provide improved security, privacy, reliability, and quality of service.

SUMMARY

(5) Embodiments of the present disclosure solve the above-described problems by providing systems, methods, and computer-readable media for hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions. Telehealth sessions may be carried out using WebRTC video conferencing between a local site (e.g., a hospital operating room) and one or more remote participants. The remote participants may connect to the telehealth session via a remote server. At the local site, local hardware may run a local server, and all devices at the local site may be connected to the local server. Media captured by the devices at the local site may be transmitted to the local server before being relayed to the remote participants. The local server may obscure portions of the data before the data leaves the local site to protect the privacy of the patient. The local server may transmit the obscured data to the remote server, and the remote server may in turn broadcast the data to the remote participants. Various aspects of the present disclosure provide a resilient architecture, which may withstand network outages, bandwidth issues, and the like while maintaining a quality telehealth session and preserving the privacy of the patient.

(6) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, including: a local server operating on a local network, the local server disposed in a first location associated with a patient; at least one local media device operating on the local network, the at least one local media device configured to capture media associated with the patient and transmit the media to the local server; and a local client device connected to the telehealth session; and a remote server disposed in a second location distinct from the first location, wherein the local server includes at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the media from the at least one local media device; obscure a portion of the media to obtain obscured media; transmit the obscured media to the remote server and to the local client device; wherein the remote server includes at least one remote server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: broadcast the obscured media to at least one remote client device connected to the telehealth session.

(7) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the first location associated with the patient is an operating room.

(8) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the remote server is

further configured to: receive remote media from the at least one remote client device; and transmit the remote media to the local server; and wherein the local server is further configured to: receive the remote media from the remote server; and broadcast the remote media to the local client device.

(9) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one local media device includes at least one camera and at least one microphone.

(10) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one local server processor is further configured to execute computer-executable instructions to record a native recording of the obscured media.

(11) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein obscuring the media includes adding a Gaussian blur to obscure an identifying feature of the patient or other information in the environment that may compromise patient privacy.

(12) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the system further includes: a standby remote server configured to be provisioned responsive to a failure of the remote server.

(13) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, including: a local server operating on a local network, the local server disposed in a first location associated with a patient; at least one local media device configured to capture media associated with the patient and transmit the media to the local server; and a remote server communicatively coupled to the local server, wherein the local server includes at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the media from the at least one local media device; obscure a portion of the media to obtain obscured media; transmit the obscured media to the remote server; wherein the remote server includes at least one remote server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: broadcast the obscured media to at least one remote client device connected to the telehealth session.

(14) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one remote server processor is configured to execute additional computer-executable instructions to: responsive to receiving remote media from the at least one remote client device, transmit the remote media to the local server.

(15) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one local server processor is configured to execute additional computer-executable instructions to: responsive to receiving the remote media from the remote server, broadcast the remote media to at least one local client device in the first location.

(16) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the system further includes a recording server including at least one recording server processor configured to execute computer executable instructions to: receive, from the local server, a local recording of the telehealth session; receive, from the remote server, a remote recording of the telehealth session; and generate a synchronized recording of the telehealth session based on the local recording and the remote recording.

(17) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one recording server processor is further configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: determine a latency between the local server and the remote server, wherein generating the synchronized recording includes synchronizing the local recording and the remote recording based on the latency.

(18) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the local server is further configured to transmit a WebRTC simulcast of the obscured media to the remote server, and wherein the remote server is further configured to simulcast the obscured media to the at least one remote client device.

(19) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, further including an additional remote server configured to be provisioned responsive to a number of remote client

devices connected to the remote server reaching a threshold number.

(20) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, including: an in-hospital network, including: a local server; a local client device connected to the local server; at least one camera for capturing video of an operation associated with the telehealth session; and at least one microphone for capturing audio associated with the telehealth session; and a plurality of remote servers communicatively coupled to the local server, wherein the local server includes at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the video from the at least one camera and the audio from the at least one microphone; and transmit the video and the audio to the plurality of remote servers; and wherein each of the plurality of remote servers includes at least one remote server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the video and the audio from the local server; and broadcast the video and the audio to one or more remote client devices.

(21) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one local server processor includes additional computer-executable instructions to: prior to transmitting the video to the plurality of remote servers, obscuring at least a portion of the video.

(22) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the local client device is configured to receive user input defining the portion of the video to obscure.

(23) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the plurality of remote servers includes at least one edge server.

(24) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, wherein the at least one local server processor includes additional computer-executable instructions to: save a native copy of the video and the audio in a network attached storage.

(25) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a system, further including: a recording server including at least one recording server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive a local recording from the local server and a remote recording from a remote server of the plurality of remote servers; and generate a composite recording of the telehealth session by comparing a frame from the local recording with a corresponding frame from the remote recording; and replace the corresponding frame from the remote recording with the frame from the local recording upon determining that the frame is associated with at least one of a higher resolution or a higher frame rate than the corresponding frame.

(26) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system for a telehealth session, including: a local server operating on a local network, the local server located in a location associated with a patient; at least one local client device connected to the local network; at least one local media device connected to the local network, wherein the at least one local media device is configured to capture media of the telehealth session in the location associated with the patient; and at least one remote server operating on a remote network; wherein the local server includes at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the media from the at least one local media device; obscure at least a portion of the media to obtain obscured media; and broadcast the obscured media to the at least one remote server; and wherein the at least one remote server includes at least one remote server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the obscured media from the local network; and responsive to receiving the obscured media, broadcast the obscured media to at least one remote participant.

(27) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein the at least one remote server includes at least one remote standby server, wherein the at least one remote standby server is a failover server for the telehealth session.

(28) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, further including: a local storage operating on the local network, wherein the local storage stores a native recording of the obscured media.

- (29) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, further including: at least one remote storage operating on the remote network, wherein the at least one remote storage stores remote recording of the telehealth session, and wherein the local server is further configured to combine the native recording and the remote recording to generate a combined recording of the telehealth session.
- (30) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein transmitting the obscured media includes adaptively streaming the obscured media to the at least one remote server based on a network quality associated with the telehealth session.
- (31) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein adaptively streaming the obscured media includes prioritizing degradations in a frame rate of the telehealth session over degradations in a bandwidth or a resolution of the telehealth session.
- (32) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein the at least one remote server includes a first remote server and a second remote server, the first remote server disposed in a first geographic location distinct from a second geographic location of the second remote server.
- (33) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to one or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by at least one processor, perform a method of hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions, including: receiving, at a local server, media data for a telehealth session from at least one local media device connected to the local server, wherein the local server is disposed in a first location associated with a patient; obscuring, at the local server, the media data to obtain obscured media; transmitting, by the local server, the obscured media to a first remote server, a second remote server, and at least one local client device connected to the local server, wherein the second remote server is a standby server for the first remote server; and responsive to receiving the obscured media at the first remote server, broadcasting the obscured media to one or more remote participants connected to the first remote server.
- (34) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: responsive to an outage in the first remote server, transitioning the one or more remote participants to the second remote server.
- (35) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: receiving, at the first remote server, remote media from a participant of the one or more remote participants; transmitting the remote media from the first remote server to the local server; and broadcasting the remote media from the local server to at least one local client device connected to the local server.
- (36) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a media, wherein the first remote server is configured to simulcast the obscured media to the one or more remote participants.
- (37) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: responsive to detecting a first change in a quality of a connection between the local server and the first remote server, reducing a frame rate of the obscured media; and responsive to detecting a second change in the quality of the connection and detecting that the frame rate of the obscured media is reduced to a predefined frame rate threshold, reducing at least one of a bit rate or a resolution of the obscured media.
- (38) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: responsive to detecting a threshold number of the one or more remote participants connected to the first remote server, provisioning a third remote server for incoming remote participants; and transmitting the obscured media to both the first remote server and the third remote server.
- (39) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, including: receiving, at a local server operating on a hospital network, local media data of an operation being performed on a patient within a hospital associated with the hospital network; applying at least one obscuration to the local media data to obtain

obscured media; transmitting the obscured media to a plurality of remote servers; responsive to receiving the obscured media at each of the plurality of remote servers, broadcasting, by at least a subset of the plurality of remote servers, the obscured media to a respective plurality of remote participants.

(40) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein the local server is configured to adaptively stream the obscured media to the plurality of remote servers, and wherein the subset of the plurality of remote servers is configured to simulcast the obscured media to the respective plurality of remote participants.

(41) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein the local server is configured to generate a local recording of the telehealth session, and wherein each of the plurality of remote servers is configured to generate a remote recording of the telehealth session.

(42) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: generating a combined recording using the local recording and the remote recording generated at each of the plurality of remote servers, wherein generating the combined recording includes determining that a frame transmitted from the local server to the plurality of remote servers did not arrive at a remote server, and replacing the frame with a corresponding frame from another remote server of the plurality of remote servers in the combined recording.

(43) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein generating the combined recording further includes synchronizing the local recording and the remote recording based on a latency between the local server and each of the subset of the plurality of remote servers.

(44) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: receiving, from a session host user, an instruction defining at least of a portion the local media data to apply the at least one obscuration.

(45) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein at least one remote server of the plurality of remote servers is a standby server.

(46) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system for a telehealth session, including: a local server operating on a local network, the local server disposed in a location associated with a patient; at least one local media device connected to the local network and configured to capture local media of the telehealth session; and at least one remote server operating on a remote network; wherein the local server includes at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the local media from the at least one local media device; broadcast the local media to the at least one remote server; and generate a first recording including the local media captured by the at least one local media device; and wherein the at least one remote server includes at least one remote server processor configured to execute further computer-executable instructions to: receive the local media from the local network; broadcast the local media to at least one remote participant; generate a second recording including data received from the at least one remote participant; log a first plurality of latencies between the local server and the at least one remote server; log a second plurality of latencies between the at least one remote server and the at least one remote participant; and generate a synchronized recording of the telehealth session based on the first recording, the second recording, the first plurality of latencies, and the second plurality of latencies.

(47) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein logging the first plurality of latencies includes determining each latency of the first plurality of latencies based on a data packet sent between the local server and the at least one remote server.

(48) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein the at least one local server processor is further configured to: apply at least one obscuration to the local media prior to transmitting the local media to the at least one remote server.

(49) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution

system, wherein each of the first plurality of latencies is a combined latency including a network latency between the local server and the at least one remote server and a computational latency associated with applying the at least one obscuration to the local media.

(50) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein the first plurality of latencies comprises a plurality of video latencies associated with video data transmitted from the local server to the remote server and a plurality of audio latencies associated with audio data transmitted from the local server to the remote server.

(51) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein the at least one local media device includes a telesurgery device, and wherein the at least one remote participant remotely operates the telesurgery device.

(52) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a hybrid media distribution system, wherein at least one of the local server or the at least one remote server is further configured to: restrict control of the remote operation of the telesurgery device in response to an increase in the second plurality of latencies.

(53) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to one or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by at least one processor, perform a method of hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions, including: receiving, at a local server, local media data of a telehealth session from at least one local media device connected to the local server, wherein the local server is disposed in a first location associated with a patient; transmitting, by the local server, the local media data to at least one remote server operating on a remote network; generating a native recording of the local media data on the local server responsive to receiving the local media data at the at least one remote server, broadcasting the local media data to one or more remote participants connected to the at least one remote server; receiving, at the at least one remote server, remote media from a remote participant from the one or more remote participants; generating a remote recording of the remote media on the at least one remote server; logging a first plurality of latencies between the local server and the at least one remote server; logging a second plurality of latencies between the at least one remote server and the one or more remote participants; and generating a synchronized recording of the telehealth session based on the native recording, the remote recording, the first plurality of latencies, and the second plurality of latencies.

(54) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: transmitting the remote media from the at least one remote server to the local server; and broadcasting the remote media from the local server to at least one local client device connected to the local server.

(55) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a media, wherein generating the synchronized recording includes adjusting a video feed associated with the remote recording based on the second plurality of latencies.

(56) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: detecting an increase in the second plurality of latencies; transmitting, by the local server, a notification indicative of the increase in the second plurality of latencies to the one or more remote participants.

(57) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: prior to transmitting the local media data to the at least one remote server, applying, by the local server, an obscuration to at least a portion of the local media data.

(58) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a media, further including: logging a plurality of computational latencies; and responsive to detecting an increase in the plurality of computational latencies, changing an obscuring method for obscuring the portion of the local media data.

(59) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, including: receiving, at a local server operating on a hospital

network, local media data of an operation being performed on a patient within a hospital associated with the hospital network; transmitting the local media data to a remote server; responsive to receiving the local media data at the remote server, broadcasting, by the remote server, the local media data to a remote participant; generating, on the local server, a first recording including the local media data; receiving remote media data from the remote participant at the remote server; transmitting the remote media data to the local server; generating, on the remote server, a second recording including the remote media data; and generating a combined recording of the telehealth session based on the first recording and the second recording; and synchronizing the combined recording by adjusting at least one of the first recording or the second recording based on a plurality of network latencies logged during the telehealth session.

(60) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein the first recording includes a first frame rate higher than a second frame rate of the second recording.

(61) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein synchronizing the combined recording further includes repeating frames from the second recording such that the second frame rate is increased to be equal to the first frame rate.

(62) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: prior to transmitting the local media data to the remote server, applying, by the local server, an obscuration to the local media data.

(63) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, further including: generating a third recording including video data captured by a telesurgery device, logging a third plurality of latencies associated with a plurality of log messages generated by the telesurgery device and transmitted to the local server, wherein the combined recording further includes the third recording, and wherein synchronizing the combined recording is further based on the third plurality of latencies.

(64) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein the local media data includes at least one of audio data, video data, telestration data, telemetry data, or telesurgery data.

(65) In some embodiments, the techniques described herein relate to a method, wherein at least one of the local server or the remote server is configured to take a correct action in response to an increase in a latency associated with the telesurgery data.

(66) This summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the detailed description. This summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used to limit the scope of the claimed subject matter. Other aspects and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent from the following detailed description of the embodiments and the accompanying drawing figures.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure are described in detail below with reference to the attached drawing figures, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 depicts an exemplary hardware platform relating to some embodiments;

(3) FIG. 2A depicts an exemplary user interface relating to some embodiments;

(4) FIG. 2B schematically depicts an exemplary hospital configured for telesurgery for some embodiments;

(5) FIG. 3A depicts a hybrid media distribution system for some embodiments;

(6) FIG. 3B depicts the hybrid media distribution system for some embodiments;

(7) FIG. 4 depicts a flowchart illustrating operation of the hybrid media distribution system for

some embodiments;

(8) FIG. 5A depicts a first method for synchronizing a local recording and a remote recording of the telehealth session for some embodiments;

(9) FIG. 5B depicts a second method for synchronizing the local recording and the remote recording of the telehealth session for some embodiments; and

(10) FIG. 6 depicts a method for calculating latency between a local media device and the local server and notifying of changes for some embodiments.

(11) The drawing figures do not limit the present disclosure to the specific embodiments disclosed and described herein. The drawings are not necessarily to scale, emphasis instead being placed upon clearly illustrating the principles of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) The following detailed description references the accompanying drawings that illustrate specific embodiments in which the present disclosure can be practiced. The embodiments are intended to describe aspects of the present disclosure in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to practice the present disclosure. Other embodiments can be utilized and changes can be made without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. The following detailed description is, therefore, not to be taken in a limiting sense. The scope of the present disclosure is defined only by the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled.

(13) In this description, references to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” or “embodiments” mean that the feature or features being referred to are included in at least one embodiment of the technology. Separate references to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” or “embodiments” in this description do not necessarily refer to the same embodiment and are also not mutually exclusive unless so stated and/or except as will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art from the description. For example, a feature, structure, act, etc. described in one embodiment may also be included in other embodiments, but is not necessarily included. Thus, the technology can include a variety of combinations and/or integrations of the embodiments described herein.

(14) Turning to FIG. 1, an exemplary hardware platform for certain embodiments is depicted. Computer **102** can be a desktop computer, a laptop computer, a server computer, a mobile device such as a smartphone or tablet, or any other form factor of general- or special-purpose computing device. Depicted with computer **102** are several components, for illustrative purposes. In some embodiments, certain components may be arranged differently or absent. Additional components may also be present. Included in computer **102** is system bus **104**, whereby other components of computer **102** can communicate with each other. In certain embodiments, there may be multiple buses or components may communicate with each other directly. Connected to system bus **104** is central processing unit (CPU) **106**. Also attached to system bus **104** are one or more random-access memory (RAM) modules **108**. Also attached to system bus **104** is graphics card **110**. In some embodiments, graphics card **110** may not be a physically separate card, but rather may be integrated into the motherboard or the CPU **106**. In some embodiments, graphics card **110** has a separate graphics-processing unit (GPU) **112**, which can be used for graphics processing or for general purpose computing (GPGPU). Also on graphics card **110** is GPU memory **114**. Connected (directly or indirectly) to graphics card **110** is display **116** for user interaction. In some embodiments no display is present, while in others it is integrated into computer **102**. Similarly, peripherals such as keyboard **118** and mouse **120** are connected to system bus **104**. Like display **116**, these peripherals may be integrated into computer **102** or absent. Also connected to system bus **104** is local storage **122**, which may be any form of computer-readable media and may be internally installed in computer **102** or externally and removably attached.

(15) Computer-readable media include both volatile and nonvolatile media, removable and nonremovable media, and contemplate media readable by a database. For example, computer-readable media include (but are not limited to) RAM, ROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other

memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile discs (DVD), holographic media or other optical disc storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage, and other magnetic storage devices. These technologies can store data temporarily or permanently and may be non-transitory computer-readable media storing data or computer-executable instructions. However, unless explicitly specified otherwise, the term “computer-readable media” should not be construed to include physical, but transitory, forms of signal transmission such as radio broadcasts, electrical signals through a wire, or light pulses through a fiber-optic cable. Examples of stored information include computer-useable instructions, data structures, program modules, and other data representations.

(16) Finally, network interface card (NIC) **124** is also attached to system bus **104** and allows computer **102** to communicate over a network such as network **126**. NIC **124** can be any form of network interface known in the art, such as Ethernet, ATM, fiber, Bluetooth®, or Wi-Fi (i.e., the IEEE 102.11 family of standards). NIC **124** connects computer **102** to local network **126**, which may also include one or more other computers, such as computer **128**, and network storage, such as data store **130**. Generally, a data store such as data store **130** may be any repository from which information can be stored and retrieved as needed. Examples of data stores include relational or object-oriented databases, spreadsheets, file systems, flat files, directory services such as LDAP and Active Directory, or email storage systems. A data store may be accessible via a complex API (such as, for example, Structured Query Language), a simple API providing only read, write, and seek operations, or any level of complexity in between. Some data stores may additionally provide management functions for data sets stored therein such as backup or versioning. Data stores can be local to a single computer such as computer **128**, accessible on a local network such as local network **126**, or remotely accessible over Internet **132**. Local network **126** is in turn connected to Internet **132**, which connects many networks such as local network **126**, remote network **134** or directly attached computers such as computer **136**. In some embodiments, computer **102** can itself be directly connected to Internet **132**.

(17) System Overview

(18) Embodiments described herein are generally directed to systems, methods, and computer-readable media for hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions. The telehealth session may be conducted using WebRTC or any other real-time communications protocol. Participants may join the telehealth session remotely by connecting to a remote server. A local server may run on hardware in the location where the medical operation is taking place, such as in a hospital operating room, or elsewhere within the hospital. The local server may operate on a local network, such as a hospital network that is not otherwise connected to the Internet. On-site devices (e.g., client computing devices, cameras, etc.) may be connected to the local server and transmit data to the local server via the local network. The local server may adjust the media from the on-site devices before transmitting the media to the remote server. For example, the local server may apply a blur effect to obscure an identifying feature of the patient being operated on to protect the privacy of the patient. Once the remote server receives the adjusted media from the local server, the remote server may broadcast the adjusted media to the remote participants as part of the telehealth session. In some embodiments, the telehealth session may be recorded. The local server and the remote server may make separate recordings that may be synchronized and combined to generate a composite recording. Latencies may be monitored for devices in the telehealth session, which may be used to synchronize the recording.

(19) FIG. 2A depicts an exemplary user interface **200** illustrating a video stream in the context of a telehealth session, which will be useful in understanding embodiments discussed herein. User interface **200** may include a plurality of video windows **202**. Each video window **202** may be associated with a separate video stream. For example, as shown, for a telesurgery, a first video window (top left) may display an in-operating room video stream of the patient and medical practitioners performing the operation, a second video window (top right) may display a video

stream of a remote participant, a third video window (bottom left) may show medical imagery of the patient being operated on, and a fourth video window may display an annotated view of the medical imagery. As discussed further below, in some embodiments, participants may annotate over portions of the video stream to assist with the telesurgery. Various other configurations of user interface **200** are within the scope hereof. In some embodiments, video windows **202** may display auxiliary information, such as a presentation that includes instructions for performing the surgery. As yet another example, a video window **202** may display data associated with the telesurgery, such as real-time vital information of the patient. Generally, the video windows may display any data stream. While four video windows **202** are illustrated, it will be appreciated that user interface **200** may comprise fewer or more than four video windows **202**.

(20) User interface **200** may comprise a toolbar **204** comprising various tools allowing a participant to participate in the telehealth session. In some embodiments, toolbar **204** comprises a chat affordance that may be actuated to cause display of a chat window (not shown) for the telehealth session. In some embodiments, a single chat window is provided for all participants. In some embodiments, participants can chat via direct messages or multiple person direct messages. In some embodiments, toolbar **204** comprises a “participants” affordance that may be actuated to view the participants of the telehealth session. Participants may be shown with status indicators, such as an indicator that the participant is using an annotation tool and an indicator that the participant is transmitting audio.

(21) In some embodiments, toolbar **204** comprises an overlay tool for overlaying content onto a video window **202**. For example, if the telesurgery is for operating on a patient's bone, x-ray imagery of the bone may be overlaid on the live video feed of the surgeon operating on the bone. In some embodiments, toolbar **204** comprises an annotation tool for annotating over the telehealth session. When actuated, the annotation tool may allow for a participant to annotate over video displayed in a video window **202**. In some embodiments, annotations **206** can be made by a participant drawing over the video. For example, a participant may use an input device (e.g., mouse, stylus, etc.) to draw on a video window **202**. In some embodiments, preconfigured annotations are provided, such as preset shapes (e.g., rectangles, circles), that can be added as annotations **206** to the video stream. Annotations may be customized, such as by choosing an annotation color, adjusting a line width of the annotation, a transparency level, or the like. In some embodiments, annotations **206** are inserted using a HTML canvas over the video stream on which annotations **206** can be written. Other markup languages may be used for inserting annotations **206** over a video stream in the telehealth session.

(22) Along with overlaying imagery and obscuring media (discussed further below), other preprocessing may be applied to the media before the media is broadcasted to the remote participants. For example, artificial intelligence techniques may be used to enhance or otherwise adjust the displayed imagery. For example, if medical imagery of the patient's tissue is being streamed, AI techniques may be used to artificially change the color of the tissue to help remote participants to better distinguish between the tissue layers. Various other preprocessing techniques may be used to enhance the video and/or audio transmitted as part of the video. For example, audio super resolution and/or video super resolution techniques may be used to upscale transmitted audio and video for the telehealth session.

(23) In some embodiments, annotations **206** can be created via augmented reality (AR) techniques. In some embodiments, an AR hand **208** is provided for annotating the video. In some embodiments, the AR hand **208** is a superimposed image of a participant's hand captured by a camera. The movement of the participant's hands may be reflected in the video, and the participant can add annotations **206** to the video via the hand movements. For example, annotations **206** may be created to call out or otherwise indicate important regions of a video. As depicted, a remote participant has drawn an annotation **206** over a portion of the heart. For example, the annotation **206** could be used to indicate an abnormality in the imagery, where to make an incision, and the

like. The use of AR annotations allows for free-form annotations to be made as the remote participant can simply move their hand to make the annotation **206**. In some embodiments, as shown in FIG. **2A**, one video window **202** displays the video stream with annotations **206** overlaid, while a second video window **202** displays the unannotated video.

(24) In some embodiments, the camera for AR hand **208** can capture imagery of the participant manipulating a tool, such as a surgical instrument, to mimic the procedure to be performed locally, and this video data may be captured and overlaid onto the video as an annotation **206**. Thus, in some embodiments, annotations may be dynamic. Other augmented reality techniques, such as the use of an augmented reality glove, or the like, are within the scope hereof. Other techniques for augmented reality annotations are discussed in U.S. Pat. No. 9,576,106, entitled “REMOTE INSTRUCTION AND MONITORING OF HEALTH CARE”, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference.

(25) Toolbar **204** may further comprise an obscure tool to indicate which regions of the video should be obscured. As previously discussed, portions of the media may need to be obscured to preserve the privacy of the patient. In some embodiments, the obscure tool may be used to define an obscure region **210** that is to be obscured before being transmitted to the other participants of the telehealth session. For example, an obscure region **210** may be defined over a region of video window **202** where the patient's face is located, and a Gaussian blur may be applied to obscure region **210** to blur the patient's face. Because the patient will generally be stationary during the operation, the obscure region **210** to be obscured may be static during the telehealth session. However, various techniques may be used to track the identified regions during the telehealth session to ensure that the regions are obscured if they move relative to the video window **202**. For example, facial tracking may be used to track the patient's face during the telehealth session, and if the patient's face moves, the obscure region **210** may be adjusted accordingly. A user may add, delete, and modify obscure region **210** during the telehealth session.

(26) In some embodiments, audio data may also be obscured. For example, audio data may be obscured by replacing the data with other audio, such as bleeping over an utterance of the patient's name, by removing the portion of the audio data from transmission, or by any other method. By obscuring data originating from the operating room before the data leaves the operating room and is transmitted to the cloud, the privacy of the patient may be preserved before the media data leaves the operating room.

(27) In some embodiments, toolbar **204** further comprises a device control tool. In some embodiments, the device control tool allows for participants to control a camera operating in the operating room remotely. For example, an in-operating room (in-OR) camera may have pan, tilt, zoom functionality, which may be controlled remotely by a remote participant via the device control tool. For example, a remote participant may be instructing a local surgeon on how to perform a medical procedure. The local surgeon may have arranged one or more in-OR cameras around the operating room to capture video while the local surgeon is performing the operation. The remote participant can adjust the positioning of the camera as needed without requiring the local surgeon to physically adjust the camera, which may be difficult while the local surgeon is performing the surgery. In some embodiments, the device control tool can be used to adjust a zoom level of the camera, how the video is displayed (e.g., changing contrast level), and the like.

(28) The device control tool may also provide control of other in-OR media devices by the remote participant. For example, the remote participant may be able to turn in-OR microphones on or off. As another example, within the OR, a display is often positioned such that the local surgeons can view the telehealth session while performing the medical procedure. The display may be placed on a movable cart or other device for positioning the display. Accordingly, in some embodiments, it is contemplated that the device control tool may enable a participant to adjust a position of the display. For example, the participant may adjust the position of the display to provide the local surgeons a better view of the display without the surgeons needing to pause the procedure to adjust

the display themselves.

(29) In some embodiments, a participant of the telehealth session operates as a session host. The session host may have control over various settings for the telehealth session. For example, the session host may initialize the telehealth session and may invite participants to join the telehealth session. As another example, the session host may configure user interface **200**, such as which information is displayed during the telehealth session. In some embodiments, each end user may configure the layout of user interface **200** such that each end user may be presented a different user interface. In some embodiments, the session host can configure the layout of user interface **200**, such as maximizing the display of a video window **202** within user interface **200** before or during the telehealth session. The session host may also configure controls on whether remote participants can transmit audio, video, chat, telestration (e.g., annotations), or any combination thereof as part of the telehealth session. In some embodiments, remote participants may be restricted from transmitting audio/video data such that the remote participants only participate via annotations and/or chat. In some embodiments, the session host is the only participant that can indicate regions of the video to be obscured. In some embodiments, the session host can designate one or more other participants to input obscure region **210**. In some embodiments, the session host is a user operating a computer connected to the local network associated with the operating room, as discussed further below.

(30) FIG. **2B** schematically depicts an exemplary hospital **250** configured for telesurgery, which will be useful in understanding embodiments discussed herein. In some embodiments, hospital **250** comprises a patient operating room **252** and one or more secondary rooms **254**. In some embodiments, the patient operating room **252** and the secondary room **254** are physically different rooms within the hospital **250**. The patient operating room **252** may be the room in which the telehealth operation (e.g., surgery) is taking place, while the secondary room **254** may be a lab room or the like that is within the hospital **250** but is separate from the patient operating room **252**. Persons in the secondary room **254** may be participating in the telehealth operation without being physically present in the patient operating room **252**. For example, the secondary room **254** may be a pathology lab performing tests on tissue removed from the patient being operated on in patient operating room **252**.

(31) In some embodiments, the hospital **250** comprises a local server **256** operating on a local network **258**. The local server **256** may be located in patient operating room **252**, secondary room **254**, or elsewhere within the hospital **250**. Client devices **260** and telesurgery devices **262** may transmit data (e.g., audio/video data, control signals, sensor data, etc.) to the local server **256** via local network **258**. While client device **260** is shown in secondary room **254**, it will be appreciated that a client device **260** may likewise be located in patient operating room **252**, e.g., a surgeon may view the telehealth session on a client device **260** while performing the surgery. In some embodiments, all network devices in hospital **250** that are participating in the telehealth session are connected to local server **256** via local network **258**. As discussed in further detail below, local server **256** may allow for local data of the telehealth session captured in hospital **250** to be processed (e.g., modified to protect patient privacy) prior to the data being transmitted out of local network **258** where the data may be accessible by persons not authorized to view private information related to the telehealth session. It is one advantage of the present disclosure that by connecting all devices within hospital **250** to local server **256** such that the in-hospital devices do not need to connect to a remote server, bandwidth savings can be realized. Further, each device may have substantially the same latency to local server **256** due to local server **256** being physically located in hospital **250**, which may reduce the computational cost of synchronizing a telehealth session recording based on latencies tracked for each device.

(32) In some embodiments, client device **260** is a smartphone, laptop, desktop computer, or any other computing device discussed above with respect to FIG. **1**. In some embodiments, client device **260** may comprise peripherals such as cameras, microphones, and input devices **264** to

capture media and input from client user **266**. Generally, the cameras or microphones may be any form of camera (e.g., a web camera) and may be connected to client device **260** wired or wirelessly. Input devices **264** may comprise a keyboard, mouse, controller, or any other input peripheral for a user **266** to provide input to client device **260**. In some embodiments, a user **266** operating client device **260** may control one or more telesurgery devices **262** located in patient operating room **252** using input devices **264**. Accordingly, in some embodiments, local server **256** may be configured to transmit instructions received from client device **260** to telesurgery device **262** to control operations thereof. For example, if telesurgery device **262** is a robotic scalpel, input device **264** may be a controller that allows the client user **266** to direct the movement of the robotic scalpel.

(33) Telesurgery devices **262** may include surgical equipment, such as robotic surgery devices, that may be used during the telesurgery and generate data. In some embodiments, telesurgery devices **262** may comprise cameras, microphones, or any other device configured to capture media or other sensor data relating to the operation of the telesurgery devices **262**. For example, telesurgery devices **262** may include a surgical tool, such as a scalpel, a drill, a suction machine, or any other surgical device. In some embodiments, cameras or microphones may be coupled directly to or integrated with the surgical tool. This coupling allows media transmitted from cameras to show precise images of the operation from the surgical tool, for example. In some embodiments, the surgical tool may be configured to capture haptic data or other sensor data. For example, if the surgical tool is a drill, the drill may capture haptic data that reflects physical feedback on the drill. This haptic data may be transmitted from the telesurgery device **262** to the client device **260** through the local server **256**. In some embodiments, telesurgery device **262** may be autonomous or semi-autonomous.

(34) In some embodiments, hospital **250** further comprises local media devices **270**. Local media devices **270** may comprise cameras, microphones, or any other device configured to capture media of the telehealth operation. For example, local media devices may include smart glasses worn by the surgeon that captures and transmits video of the surgery to capture a first-person perspective of the surgery. Generally, the cameras may be any form of camera and may transmit data to local server **256** wired or wirelessly. In some embodiments, local media devices **270** may capture media of a patient **272** independent of telesurgery devices **262**. In some embodiments, microphones may be placed around the operating room **252** to capture audio of the telehealth session. In some embodiments, local media devices **270** includes a display monitor located in patient operating room **252** for persons in patient operating room **252** to view and/or participate in the telehealth session.

(35) Local server **256** may comprise a message broker (see FIG. 3A) for managing communications between devices **260**, **262**, **268** during the telehealth session. The message broker may utilize a publication-subscription architecture and may be, for example, MQTT 5.0. In some embodiments, each device **260**, **262**, **268** participating in a telehealth session registers with the telehealth session provider prior to the telehealth session. The registration may comprise each device **260**, **262**, **268** undergoing a security protocol to authenticate the device. In some embodiments, each device **260**, **262**, **268** may be required to have requisite security credentials to join a specific telehealth session. Accordingly, once registered, the devices **260**, **262**, **268** may communicate with one another and exchange data with the privacy of the exchanged data being guaranteed. Furthermore, by registering with the telehealth session provider, the device data can be associated with the device within the telehealth session. For example, if a telesurgery device **262** captures and transmits video during a surgical operation, the video can be linked to the device based on the pre-registration of the device. For example, the robotic device video may be displayed in a video window **202** and labeled “Video from Robotic Device 1.”

(36) The message broker may also be used to determine latency for devices **260**, **262**, **268** during the telehealth session, which may be used to generate a synchronized recording of the telehealth session, as discussed in further detail hereinafter. In some embodiments, messages sent between the message broker and devices **260**, **262**, **268** comprise timestamps that may be used to determine a

latency therebetween. In some embodiments, the message broker and/or a device **260, 262, 268** sends a message that is configured to be sent round trip such that the initial send time and the return time can be used to determine the latency between the message broker and the sending device **260, 262, 268**. The message may be a data packet configured only for measuring latency, or the message may include data related to the telehealth session (e.g., sensor data from a biometric device) having a timestamp from which the latency can be determined. For example, the message may be a log message from a biometric sensor that includes sensor data along with a timestamp, and the timestamp may be used to determine latency. For example, the biometric sensor may communicate the log message to local server **256** along with the timestamp indicating when the log message was transmitted, local server **256** may transmit the log message back to the biometric sensor, and the biometric sensor may compare the time at which the log message was returned to the timestamp to determine the latency to local server **256**. In some embodiments, local server **256** determines the latency based on the timestamp and the time at which the log message was received at local server **256**. In some embodiments, prior to the telehealth session beginning, device clocks may be synchronized to accurately determine latency based on timestamps. In some embodiments, the message broker periodically (e.g., at regular or irregular intervals) broadcasts a message to all or a subset of connected devices **260, 262, 268** that is returned and used to determine the latency from the message broker (running on local server **256**) to each device **260, 262, 268**. In some embodiments, WebRTC statistics, jitter buffers, and the like may also be used to determine latency for devices **260, 262, 268**.

(37) By tracking latency for devices **260, 262, 268** a recording of the telehealth session can be generated that is synchronized to the point of data capture for each device. For example, if a telesurgery device **262** has a camera that captures video that is transmitted to local server **256** with 5 ms latency, the video may be time shifted by 5 ms when the recording is generated. Thus, if the telesurgery device **262** is also measuring sensor data, the captured video may be synchronized to the measured sensor data. Generating such a synchronized recording may be useful when reviewing a telehealth session operation, where it may be critical to have the video data exactly aligned with the sensor data because of the critical events that may happen with the period of latency between capturing and transmitting the video data and the logging of sensor data, for example.

(38) It will be appreciated that various other types of latency besides latency for a video feed may be tracked, logged, monitored, or any combination thereof without departing from the scope hereof, and these latencies may similarly be used to adjust various parts of the telehealth session. For example, latency of audio data transmitted during the telehealth session may be tracked and used during and/or after the telehealth session to make adjustments to the telehealth session. Similarly to synchronizing video feeds based on latency, audio feeds may be synchronized when generating recordings of the telehealth session. Tracking latency for audio during the telehealth session may also be used for making other adjustments to the audio, such as for synthesizing the audio data, or performing any other processing to the audio data. For example, when generating the composite recording, it may be desired to adjust the volume of an audio stream, such as the audio of the surgeon performing the surgery.

(39) As discussed herein, generally, latency can be tracked for any device that is transmitting data as part of the telehealth session. Other examples of data that may have latency tracked/monitored/etc. include, but are not limited to: latency for sensor readings (e.g., to be transmitted from a surgical device to local server **256**); input latency (e.g., for remotely controlling a surgical tool); ping latency; and computational latency (e.g., for applying an obscuration to the video). One of skill in the art will appreciate various other data that may be transmitted during the telehealth session and the latency for said data may be tracked and used to adjust the recording and/or for logging purposes to review after a telehealth session.

(40) As discussed further below, in some embodiments, latency is assumed to be symmetric. That is, the latency between two devices (e.g., between local server **256** and a remote server, between a

telesurgery device **262** and local server **256**, etc.) is assumed to be the same when sending data from the first device to the second device. For example, the latency between local server **256** and remote server (as discussed further below) may be calculated by sending a round trip data packet between the two servers, and halving the time it takes for the data packet to return to the sender. However, in some embodiments, determining the latency is based on an assumption that the latency between two devices is asymmetrical. Thus, using the above example, a first latency may be determined for the time it takes for the data packet to be sent from the local server to the remote server may be determined, and a second latency may be determined for the time it takes the data packet to be sent from the remote server to the local server. The latency monitoring of a telehealth session may monitor latency using both symmetric latency calculations and asymmetric latency calculations. For example, for devices where it is more critical to track the latency (e.g., remotely controlled surgical devices), asymmetric latency may be assumed to ensure greater accuracy, while latency between less critical components may be assumed symmetric to save processing power in calculating the latencies.

(41) Monitoring the latency may further be used to prevent unsafe operations of a telesurgery device **262**. In some embodiments, if the local server **256** detects a latency above a threshold between for telesurgery devices **262**, local server **256** may broadcast a notification to the controlling client device **260** indicative of the high latency. In some embodiments, if the local server **256** detects the latency exceeding the threshold between the telesurgery devices **262** and client device **260**, local server **256** may limit the control of telesurgery devices **262** by the controlling user. For example, if telesurgery device **262** is a robotic scalpel, local server **256** may prevent a user from directing the scalpel to make an incision for a time during high network latency. As previously discussed, it is contemplated that each device in the telehealth session may monitor the device's own latency and, accordingly, broadcast to one or more other devices or servers that the device is experiencing aberrant latency. Remote control of telesurgery devices **262** may likewise be limited for remote participants of the telehealth session, as discussed in further detail below.

(42) Hybrid Media Distribution

(43) FIG. 3A illustrates a system **300** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, system **300** facilitates hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session that protects the privacy of the patient involved in the telehealth session. System **300** may also provide resiliency against network outages, reduced latency, and improvements in security and recordings of telehealth sessions as discussed further herein.

(44) In some embodiments, system **300** comprises a local server **302** that comprises or is otherwise associated with an encoder **304**, a network attached storage (NAS) **306**, a local message broker **308a**, or any combination thereof. In some embodiments, local server **302** may be local server **256** described above. A local client device **310** and local media devices **312** may transmit media data to the local server **302**. In some embodiments, local media devices **312** comprise cameras **314**, microphones **316**, or any other device configured to obtain data associated with a medical procedure. For example, local media devices **312** may comprise medical equipment configured to take sensor readings associated with the operation. The local server **302**, local client device **310**, and local media devices **312** may be connected via a local network **318**. Media received from local devices **310**, **312** by local server **302** may be transmitted to a remote server **320**. Remote server **320** may broadcast the media to remote client devices **322**. Local server **302** and remote server **320** may be communicatively coupled to a recording server **324** for generating recordings of the telehealth session, as discussed further below.

(45) In some embodiments, local server **302** is a WebRTC server configured for live video conferencing. In some embodiments, local server **302** is a JANUS® WebRTC server. In some embodiments, local server **302** runs locally on hardware located within local network **318**. For example, local network **318** may be a WLAN hospital network, and local server **302** may run on

hardware disposed in an operating room, or elsewhere within the hospital. Local server **302** may transmit data received from local devices **310**, **312** to the remote servers **320**.

(46) Data transmitted during the telehealth session may include audio data, video data, chat data, telestration data, telesurgery data, telemetry data or any combination thereof. In some embodiments, video data is transmitted on a first channel, audio transmitted on a second channel, and chat/telestration data are transmitted together on a third channel. In some embodiments, each video stream is transmitted as a separate video stream. For example, if local client device **310** and camera **314** are both streaming video, local server **302** may forward each video stream separately to remote server **320**. In some embodiments, local server **302** is configured to mix audio received from local devices **310**, **312** into a single stream that is transmitted as a single audio stream to remote server **320**. Telesurgery and telemetry data are discussed further below.

(47) By connecting local devices **310**, **312** to a local server **302** instead of to a remote server **320**, the quality of service for the telehealth session may be improved. For example, the latency is reduced as the local devices **310**, **312** are no longer required to transmit data over an Internet connection. Additionally, the privacy of the data can be preserved, as the data can be manipulated before it leaves the local network **318**. The use of a local server **302** also allows for media captured by devices **310**, **312** to be recorded at their native resolution, which, in some embodiments, is saved to NAS **306**. Furthermore, the use of local server **302** can reduce latency when streaming data from local devices **310**, **312**, as these devices no longer need to stream data to a remote server over an Internet connection. Accordingly, the quality of service for the telehealth session may be improved as the stability of distribution is less reliant on network connectivity of local devices **310**, **312**.

(48) In some embodiments, local message broker **308a** is configured to manage communication between the various devices within local network **318**. As discussed above, the telehealth session may be carried out as a WebRTC session utilizing a publication/subscription architecture. In some embodiments, local message broker **308a** utilizes MQTT to manage subscriptions for local devices **310**, **312** to the telehealth session. Other message brokers may be utilized without departing from the scope hereof. In some embodiments, local message broker **308a** can transmit instructions to local server **302**. For example, local message broker **308a** may instruct local server **302** to not transmit data received from local media devices **312** until the encoder **304** has applied the necessary obstructions/obscurations (e.g., Gaussian blur). While local message broker **308a** is illustrated as associated with local server **302**, the functionality of local message broker **308a** may be carried out by any device operating in local network **318** in some embodiments. For example, local message broker **308a** may instead run on a local client device **310**, such as the session hosting client device. In some embodiments, local message broker **308a** also handles remote control of local devices **312**. As discussed above, participants may use a device control tool to adjust positioning and/or operations of a device within local network **318**. Messages sent between client devices **310**, **322** for controlling local devices (e.g., cameras **314**, displays, etc.) may be managed by local message broker **308a**. In some embodiments, a remote message broker **308b** operates on or in association with one or more remote servers **320**, and the remote message broker **308b** may relay messages received from remote client devices **322** to local message broker **308a**. In some embodiments, each remote server **320** is associated with a remote message broker **308b**. For example, instructions received from a remote client device **322** to adjust the positioning of a camera in the operating remote may be relayed from the remote message broker **308b** to the local message broker **308a**.

(49) The local client device **310** may be any form of computing device discussed above with respect to FIG. 1. In some embodiments, a local client device **310** operates as the session host for the telehealth session. Local client device **310** may be client device **260** described above. A local participant operating the session-hosting client device **310** may configure various parameters for the telehealth session. For example, the local participant may invite one or more remote participants to participate in the telehealth session. In some embodiments, the local client device

310 is associated with one or more local media devices **312** transmitting media to the local server **302**. For example, the one or more local client devices **310** may comprise a web camera and a microphone to stream data of the user operating one or more local client devices **310**, as part of the telehealth session.

(50) As mentioned above, local media device **312** may comprise cameras **314**, microphones **316**, or any other device configured to capture media of the telehealth operation. In some embodiments, local media device **312** may be local media device **268** described above. In some embodiments, the camera **314** may be an IP camera that wirelessly transmits video data to local server **302**. As another example, the camera **314** may be on a surgical instrument that is inserted into the patient to capture internal imagery of the patient during surgery. Generally, the camera **314** may be any form of camera and may transmit data to local server **302** wired or wirelessly. Microphones **316** may be disposed around the operating room to capture audio data during the operation. For example, each local surgeon may wear a microphone **316** to capture their audio such that the local surgeon can communicate with the remote participants during the surgery. Various other devices or sensors configured to transmit data to local server **302** are within the scope hereof. For example, sensor data from a monitoring device that is monitoring the patient's vitals may be transmitted as part of the telehealth session and rendered for display on user interface **200**. As another example, medical imagery devices may transmit image data to local server **302** for display in a video window **202**. For example, an imaging device may obtain imagery of the patient's heart shown and transmit the data as part of the telehealth session as shown in FIG. 2A above.

(51) In some embodiments, the local media device **312** may be a telemetry or telesurgery device as previously discussed. For example, the telemetry device may be a monitoring device for tracking the vitals (e.g., heartbeat) of a patient. In some embodiments, local server **302** is configured to transmit the telemetry data to remote server **320**. For example, if local media devices **312** are medical devices that capture telemetry data, the local server **302** may transmit telemetry to remote server **320** for remote users to interpret the telemetry data from the local media device **312**. Streaming telemetry data allows remote users to respond immediately to events within the operating room without relying on a user to relay feedback to remote users. In some embodiments, the local server **302** may be configured to send a notification within the telehealth session of events based on telemetry data. In some embodiments, the local server **302** and the remote server **320** are configured to relay instructions from remote client devices **322** or local client devices **310** to the local media device **312**. In some embodiments, the local server **302** and the remote server **320** are configured to transmit feedback, such as haptic feedback, from the telesurgery device to remote client devices **322** or local client devices **310**. For example, the telesurgery device might be a robotic scalpel. A user of a local client device or a remote client device may control the operation of the robotic scalpel. Haptic feedback transmitted from the robotic scalpel may indicate the physical response of the robotic scalpel.

(52) Media data captured by local devices **310**, **312** may be transmitted to local server **302** for distribution to remote server **320**. Prior to distributing media to remote server **320**, local server **302** may adjust at least a portion of the received media data. In some embodiments, local server **302** adjusts the video stream using encoder **304**. For example, the video stream may be adjusted to blur the face (or other body region) of the patient being operated on. Other identifying features, such as tattoos or piercings, may also be adjusted to protect the privacy of the patient. Generally, any portion of the video may be obscured by local server **302**. For example, if camera **314** captures video that includes a clock in the operating room, the clock may be obscured to remove time and/or date information relating to the operation. In some embodiments, a Gaussian blur or other blur type is applied. One of skill in the art will appreciate the various adjustments that may be made to the video stream to protect the privacy of the patient. Audio data may also be obscured as discussed above. In some embodiments, encoder **304** is FFmpeg or any other encoder.

(53) In some embodiments, the local server **302** may determine and/or log a computational latency

for obscuring the video or performing any other intervention in local media before transmitting the local media out of local network **318**. The computational latency may be tracked by logging the processing time it takes for computing the adjustments to the telehealth session to include the intervention. In some embodiments, if at least one of the computational latency or the latency between the local server **302** to a remote server **320** is above a threshold latency, the local server **302** may switch from a more computationally expensive obscuration to a less computationally expensive obscuration to reduce latency. In some embodiments, the detection of excess computational latency causes a change from a first obscuration type to a second obscuration type. For example, instead of using a Gaussian blur, a less computationally expensive graphic overlay, such as a black box, may be rendered over the video portions that are to be obscured.

(54) After adjusting the media received from one or more local media devices **312**, local server **302** may transmit the adjusted or obscured media to the remote server **320**. In some embodiments, the remote server **320** is configured as a separate instance of the local server **302**. For example, the remote server **320** may be a separate JANUS® instance. In some embodiments, remote servers **320** are containerized instances that are dynamically provisioned upon initialization of a telehealth session. In some embodiments, provisioning of remote servers **320** is determined using latency-based testing. Remote servers **320** with the lowest latency between the server and local server **302** may be selected. In some embodiments, the latency-based testing also takes into consideration latency between the remote server **320** and one or more remote client devices **322**. In some embodiments, the local server **302** is configured as a minimal version of the remote server **320**. For example, local server **302** may have reduced functionality as compared to remote server **320**.

Remote servers **320** may broadcast the received obscured media to the remote client devices **322**.

(55) In some embodiments, local server **302** is configured to transmit the video and/or audio as a simulcast to remote server **320**. That is, local server **302** may send media at various qualities as a simulcast to remote server **320**, and remote server **320** may in turn forward the media at the quality level required by each remote client device **322**. For example, local server **302** may transmit a first copy of a video stream at 4 k, 60 fps, a second copy of the video stream at 1080p, 30 pfs, and a third copy of the video stream at 720p, 30 fps to remote server **320**. Remote server **320** may then transmit one of the three copies of the video stream to each remote client device **322** based on the network connectivity of each remote client device **322**. In some embodiments, simulcasting of the video streams may be based on the layout of user interface **200**. For example, if a video window **202** is enlarged and other video windows **202** are reduced in size, the video stream for the enlarged video window **202** may be broadcast at a higher quality, and the video streams for the reduced video windows **202** may be broadcast at a lower quality. Audio data may also be transmitted using simulcasting techniques. In some embodiments, remote client devices **322** can participate in the session by transmitting audio, video, chat, and telestration data. Accordingly, in some embodiments, remote server **320** may transmit media received from remote client devices **322** to local server **302** as a simulcast to local server **302**, and local server **302** simulcasts the media to local client device **310**. In some embodiments, the simulcast is a WebRTC simulcast. In some embodiments, the WebRTC simulcast comprises a server **302**, **320** encoding three streams at three separate bitrates and transmitting the video stream at one of the three bitrates to a client device **310**, **322** based on the network connectivity or bandwidth of the client device **310**, **322**. In some embodiments, local server **302** and/or remote server **320** operates as a selective forwarding unit to relay streams to client devices **310**, **322** based on the needs of the client devices. In some embodiments, local server **302** adaptively streams the telehealth session to remote server **320**, as discussed further below with respect to FIG. 3B.

(56) In some embodiments, system **300** comprises a single remote server **320** connected to each remote client device **322** participating in the telehealth session. In some embodiments, system **300** comprises a plurality of remote servers **320**, with each of the plurality of remote servers **320** connected to one or more remote client devices **322**. When multiple remote servers **320** are

employed, local server **302** may replicate and transmit data for the telehealth session to each remote server **320**. The use of multiple remote servers **320** may improve resiliency of the telehealth session as one or more of the remote servers may be employed as a warm standby/failover server in the event of a failure of another remote server. Thus, the single point of failure presented by only using a single remote server **320** may be eliminated. Furthermore, the remote servers may be located in distinct geographical locations and connected to remote participants based on a geographic proximity, thereby reducing latency for the remote participants. Other uses and advantages of providing a plurality of remote servers **320** for a telehealth session are discussed further hereinafter. (57) Multiple remote servers **320** may be utilized for scaling in some embodiments. For example, in some embodiments, a single remote server **320** may be configured to support up to 50 remote client devices **322**. Accordingly, when the number of remote client devices **322** nears, reaches, or exceeds 50, an additional remote server **320** may be provisioned and newly-joining remote client devices **322** may be connected to the additional remote server **320**. Other threshold numbers (e.g., 10, 20, 100, etc.) for determining when to provision a new remote server **320** are within the scope hereof.

(58) Multiple remote servers **320** may also be utilized when remote participants are located in geographically distinct areas. For example, if a first subset of remote client devices **322** are located in Europe, and a second subset of remote client devices **322** are located in North America, a first remote server **320** located in Europe may be provisioned for the first subset of remote client devices **322**, and a second remote server **320** located in North America may be provisioned for the second subset of remote client devices **322**. Thus, the latency for the remote client devices **322** may be improved by connecting remote client devices **322** to geographically proximate remote servers **320**.

(59) In some embodiments, a remote server **320** may be kept on standby during a telehealth session. For example, all remote client devices **322** may connect to a first remote server **320** for the telehealth session, and a second remote server **320** can be kept on standby and not connected to any remote client device **322**. Accordingly, if the first remote server **320** suffers a loss of service or can no longer maintain a requisite quality of service, the remote client devices **322** can be automatically joined to the standby remote server **320** with only a minimum interruption for remote client devices **322**. Further, if a standby remote server **320** is provisioned to take over for a failed remote server **320**, in some embodiments, a new standby remote server **320** is then provisioned. In some embodiments, local server **302** is configured to forward data to both the in-use remote server **320** and the standby remote server **320** to minimize the disruption in service if the in-use remote server **320** fails. Both the in-use remote server **320** and the standby remote server **320** may record the telehealth session such that, if the in-use remote server **320** fails, the recording is not lost when switching to the standby remote server **320**. In some embodiments, each remote server **320** connected to remote client devices **322** has a server on standby. In some embodiments, a single standby remote server **320** is provisioned regardless of the number of in-use remote servers **320**. In some embodiments, a standby server is provisioned for a predefined number of remote servers **320**. For example, a standby server may be provisioned for every three remote servers **320**. In some embodiments, a standby server is provisioned for remote servers based on geographic proximity. For example, if remote servers are located in distinct geographic regions, at least one standby server may be provisioned for each geographic region.

(60) In some embodiments, a backup remote server **320** may be provisioned and ran via a 5G connection in the event of a failure of a remote server **320**. For example, if both the in-use remote server **320** and the standby remote server **320** were to fail, system **300** may be configured to provision a remote server **320** ran on a 5G connection. In some such embodiments, once connectivity to one of the in-use or the standby remote server **320** is restored, the remote client devices **322** may be reconnected thereto. It is further contemplated that a 5G server may be provisioned (or held on standby) in the case of failure of local server **302**.

(61) In some embodiments, one or more remote servers **320** may be regional or edge servers that are located geographically proximate to the local network **318**. In some embodiments, regional remote servers **320** can relay data from local server **302** further out to other remote servers **320**. Such an embodiment may be useful when the hospital is located in an area with strong regional Internet connectivity but slower international Internet connectivity. For example, international Internet connectivity may be done via satellite, which may be a limiting factor when conducting a live video conferencing session when remote participants are located in a different country than local network **318** due to latency and/or bandwidth limitation between local server **302** and remote server **320**. Accordingly, a regional remote server **320** can be located out of local network **318** but proximal thereto (e.g., within the city or country of local network **318**) and relay feeds from local server **302** to other remote servers **320** that are located internationally, or to a satellite that relays the feed to a remote server **320**. In some embodiments, an edge server can function as the local server **302**. Thus, in some embodiments, it is contemplated that the local server **302** is not physically located in the hospital. Connecting to such edge servers may be done using a VPN to ensure the security of the telehealth session.

(62) As another example, edge remote servers **320** may be used to host a telehealth session when all remote participants are within the same region, such as when remote participants are video conferencing in from hospitals in nearby towns, counties, cities, etc. to the hospital running on local network **318**. Accordingly, the need for a remote server **320** that is provisioned from an arbitrary location may be eliminated. If a remote participant located outside of the regional area serviced by the edge remote server **320** joins the telehealth session, an additional remote server **320** can be provisioned for the participant. The use of regional remote servers **320** that are local to the local network **318** may ensure quality of service is maintained for the telehealth session.

(63) In some embodiments, when multiple remote servers **320** are used, each remote server **320** is configured to mix the audio received from the connected remote client devices **322** and forwards the audio mix to local server **302**. Local server **302** may then mix the audio into a final audio mix that is distributed to each of the remote servers **320**. For example, if two remote servers **320** are used and each remote server **320** receives two audio streams from two remote client devices **322**, each remote server **320** may mix the two audio streams and relay the mixed audio stream to local server **302** such that the local server **302** receives a single audio stream from each remote server **320**. Once received, local server **302** may further mix the two mixed audio streams into a single audio stream (which may also include any audio received from local media devices **312**) and send the single audio stream back to each remote server **320** for broadcasting to the remote client devices **322**. To avoid echo, each server **302**, **320** may transmit audio with an identifier or other metadata that identifies the source of the audio. Accordingly, if a server **302**, **320** receives audio that has already been forwarded from another server **302**, **320**, the receiving server **302**, **320** may refrain from re-forwarding the already forwarded audio to prevent audio echo.

(64) In some embodiments, local server **302** and one or more remote servers **320** are connected to a recording server **324**. As discussed further below with respect to FIGS. 5A and 5B, local server **302** and/or remote server **320** may generate recordings of the telehealth session. In some embodiments, servers **302**, **320** transmit the recordings to recording server **324** for processing. For example, recording server **324** may synchronize and/or combine the recordings, as discussed below. In some embodiments, local server **302** and/or remote server **320** are configured with the functionality of recording server **324**. In some embodiments, recording server **324** resides within local network **318**.

(65) FIG. 3B illustrates a system **350** for carrying out embodiments of the present disclosure. System **350** may be substantially similar to system **300** described above. System **350** illustrates how broadcasting of the telehealth session may be performed in order to provide a more resilient and secure system. System **350** may comprise a local server **352**, local storage **354**, one or more local participants **356**, and one or more local client devices **358**. Local server **352** may correspond

to local server **302** discussed above. Local storage **354** may correspond to NAS **306** discussed above. The one or more local client devices **358** may correspond to local client devices **310** discussed above.

(66) Local server **352** may be communicatively coupled to one or more remote servers **360**, which may correspond to remote servers **320**. At least one of the remote servers **360** may comprise a remote storage **362** for storing data associated with the telehealth session. In some embodiments, each remote server **360** includes remote storage **362**. Each of the one or more remote servers **360** may broadcast data to one or more remote participants **364**, corresponding to remote client devices **322** discussed above. While not shown in FIG. **3B**, it will be appreciated that other components illustrated with respect to FIG. **3A** may also be present in FIG. **3B**, such as message brokers **308a**, **308b**, or any other component discussed above with respect to system **300**.

(67) As shown, local server **352** may transmit data for the telehealth conference to the one or more remote servers **360**. Local server **352** may replicate the data transmission for each remote server **360** that has been provisioned for the telehealth session (including any standby servers, if present). In some embodiments, local server **352** employs adaptive streaming techniques when transmitting the telehealth session. The adaptive streaming may comprise local server **352** adjusting one or more video quality parameters for the telehealth session based on network conditions. For example, one or more of the frame rate, bit rate, or resolution of the telehealth session may be adjusted by local server **352** responsive to changes in network quality. For example, a rural hospital may have a poor network connection from local server **352** to a remote server **360**. Accordingly, local server **352** may transmit the telehealth session to the remote server **360** at a lower frame rate to compensate for the poor network connection.

(68) When connected to greater than one remote server **360**, local server **352** may adaptively stream the telehealth session to each remote server **360** such that different remote servers **360** may receive the telehealth session streamed at different quality levels. For example, local server **352** may be connected to a first remote server **360** and to a second remote server **360**, and the connection between local server **352** and the second remote server **360** may be worse than the connection between local server **352** and the first remote server **360**. Accordingly, local server **352** may transmit the telehealth session to the first remote server **360** at a first quality level and, when it is detected that the connection between local server **352** and the second remote server degrades, local server **352** may adjust the streaming to second remote server **360** while maintaining the quality transmitted to first remote server **360**.

(69) In some embodiments, local server **352** is configured to preferentially adjust one quality parameter over the other quality parameters (e.g., frame rate, bit rate, resolution). That is, responsive to determining that an adjustment to a video quality parameter is needed, local server **352** may adjust one of the bit rate, the frame rate, or the resolution before adjusting the other parameters. For example, local server **352** may preferentially adjust the frame rate before making changes to either the bit rate or the resolution. Degrading the frame rate before the bit rate or the resolution allows for the image quality of the telehealth session to be maintained, which may be important for remote participants who are viewing the telehealth session and may be assisting the local surgeons in performing the procedure. In some embodiments, either the bit rate or the resolution may be adjusted preferentially over the frame rate. In some embodiments, the telehealth session is configured to be streamed at 30 fps, and local server **352** decreases the frame rate to 15 fps before adjusting either the bit rate or the resolution. In some embodiments, the telehealth session is configured to be streamed at 24 fps, and local server **352** decreases the frame rate to 12 fps before adjusting either the bit rate or the resolution.

(70) In some embodiments, once the frame rate is decreased to a threshold frame rate, if further adjustments need to be made by local server **352** to the adaptive streaming of the telehealth session, at least one of the bit rate or the resolution are then adjusted. The threshold frame rate may be 12 fps, 15 fps, or any other frame rate and may be predefined by a user, such as the session host. By

maintaining a minimum threshold frame rate, the latency of the telehealth session may be prevented from excessively increasing. For example, when streaming at 30 fps, 30 ms of latency is inherent in the telehealth session and lowering the frame rate to 15 fps doubles the latency to 60 ms. Accordingly, if a further frame rate reduction occurs, the latency would likewise increase. As such, defining a minimum frame rate threshold allows for latency due to the frame rate to be controlled. Similarly, if either the bit rate or the resolution is adjusted before the other parameters, a minimum bit rate or resolution may be set that will prevent further degradations of the parameter and result in a different parameter being adjusted.

(71) Each remote server **360** may be communicatively coupled to a respective plurality of remote participants **364**, and each remote server **360** may broadcast the received data stream(s) for the telehealth session to the respective plurality of remote participants **364**. As previously discussed, each remote server **360** may support 50 remote participants **364**, although embodiments of the present disclosure may include fewer or greater remote participants **364** connected to a remote server **360** without departing from the scope hereof. In some embodiments, one or more of the remote servers **360** is configured to simulcast the telehealth session based on the network quality of each remote participant **364**. The simulcast may be a WebRTC simulcast wherein three bitrates of the telehealth are generated, and one of the three bitrates is streamed to a remote participant based on the needs of the remote participant **364** as previously discussed. System **350** may employ other adaptive bitrate streaming techniques (e.g., MPEG-DASH, etc.) without departing from the scope hereof.

(72) Remote participants **364** may participate in the telehealth session as previously discussed. Remote participants **364** may send any combination of audio, video, or chat/telestration data. The remote participants **364** may transmit the data to their respective remote server **360**, and the remote server **360** routes the data to the local server **352**. Aspects of the present disclosure may reduce latency in the telehealth session by providing a single local server **352** connected to the participants **356** (i.e., client devices) and local media devices **358**. Because there may be multiple one or more local participants **356** viewing the telehealth session within the hospital network, latency may be reduced as each of the one or more local participants **356** only connect to local server **352** rather than each participant **356** separately connecting remote server **360**. Accordingly, the download bandwidth requirements are reduced, and a single connection to remote server **360** made by local server **352** can be used to receive telehealth session data from remote servers **360**, which may then be broadcast the data to the participants **356**.

(73) As discussed in further detail below, embodiments of the present disclosure may provide for improved reliability in generating recordings of the telehealth session. Recordings of the telehealth session may be used for record keeping purposes, teaching/lecturing purposes, and the like. Maintaining a high-quality recording of the session provides for improvements in teaching, lecturing, training, etc. of medical procedures.

(74) As shown, each local server **352** and the one or more remote servers **360** includes storage **354**, **362**. Storage **354**, **362** may be configured to store recordings of the telehealth session, among other data relating thereto, as will be appreciated by one of skill in the art. In some embodiments, local storage **354** is configured to store a high-quality version of at least a portion of the telehealth session. The high-quality version may include recordings from some or all of the local media generated within local network **318** at a native quality. For example, if one or more local client devices **358** includes a 4 k camera capturing the surgical operations at 30 fps, local storage **354** may include a native recording of this data. Meanwhile, when data captured from the 4 k camera is streamed to remote server **360**, the data will likely be streamed at a lesser quality (e.g., at 720p and 15 fps) because of network constraints. Thus, by routing data captured by one or more local client devices **358** to local server **352**, a high-quality recording of the telehealth session may be persevered regardless of the quality of the connection between local server **352** and remote server **360**. Local storage **354** may also record incoming data transmitted from remote server **360**, such as

any data from one or more remote participants **364**.

(75) Remote storage **362** may also record data for the telehealth session. The recording generated at remote storage **362** may serve as a backup for the recording generated at **354** in some embodiments. The remote recording may be a compressed recording as the data from one or more local participants **356** and one or more local client devices **358** may be compressed when transmitted from local server **352** to remote server **360**. Recordings stored at remote storage **362** may be transmitted to local storage **354** or another location (e.g., recording server **324**) for combining the recordings to generate a synchronized recording, as discussed further below. In some embodiments, at least one remote participant **364** is configured to generate a local recording of any data generated by the at least one remote participant **364**. The local recording may be later uploaded to remote server **360** for generating the combined recording.

(76) FIG. **4** illustrates an exemplary method **400** for carrying out a telehealth session using a hybrid media distribution system **300** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. At step **402**, media data from one or more local media devices **312** may be received at the local server **302**. The media data may comprise audio data and/or video data of the operation being performed. In some embodiments, media data is also received from local client devices **310**. For example, a local client device **310** may have an associated web camera and microphone to stream audio and video of a user operating the local client device **310**. The media data may also include chat and/or annotation data inputted via local client device **310**. As discussed previously, sending media from devices **310**, **312** to a local server **302** instead of to a remote server **320** can lower latency for the telehealth session. Eliminating the requirement for local devices **310**, **312** to connect to a remote server **320** may be beneficial for areas where Internet connectivity is poor.

(77) Next, at step **404**, local server **302** may obscure a portion of the received, local media data. The data may be obscured in various ways. For example, the obscuring may comprise blurring, by encoder **304**, identifying features of the patient. In some embodiments, local message broker **308a** instructs local server **302** to prevent relaying the media data until encoder **304** has modified the data. In some embodiments, a participant of the telehealth session defines one or more obscure regions **210** for a video stream. In some embodiments, only the session host can define obscure region **210**. By obscuring data within local network **318**, privacy of the patient may be preserved before the media data leaves the local network **318**. In some embodiments, one or more firewalls (not shown) associated with local network **318** may prevent devices located outside of the hospital from connecting to local server **302**.

(78) At step **406**, local server **302** may transmit the obscured media to one or more remote servers **320**. As previously discussed, each remote server **320** may be a separate instance of the local server **302**. When multiple remote servers **320** are employed, local server **302** may transmit data for the telehealth session to each remote server **320** separately. In some embodiments, local server **302** forwards the data to an edge server, and the edge server propagates the data to other remote servers **320**. In some embodiments, media for the telehealth session is sent on at least three separate channels: a channel for audio data, a channel for telestration/chat data, and one or more channels for each video stream (i.e., one channel per video stream). It is contemplated that telestration data and chat data may have separate channels. In some embodiments, local server **302** adaptively streams the telehealth session to the remote servers **320** as previously discussed. When an adjustment to the telehealth session quality needs to be made, local server **302** may lower the frame rate before either the bit rate or the resolution.

(79) At step **408**, the remote server **320** may broadcast the obscured media to one or more remote client devices. In some embodiments, remote server **320** broadcasts the obscured media as a simulcast, which may be a WebRTC simulcast wherein three encodings are generated, and an encoding of the three encodings are sent to each remote client device **322** based on the quality of the connection between the remote client device **322** and remote server **320**. Because the media data may be at least partially obscured, the remote participants may be unable to identify the patient

in the telehealth session, thereby preserving the privacy of the patient. As previously discussed, remote participants may also participate in the telehealth session by streaming audio and/or video, along with transmitting chat and telestration data. Accordingly, at step **410**, the remote client devices **322** may transmit media data to the remote servers **320**. The session host may configure which (if any) remote participants can stream video and/or audio data as part of the telehealth session.

(80) At step **412**, the remote server **320** may transmit the received media data to the local server **302**. Data received from a remote client device **322** may also be relayed by the remote server **320** to other remote client devices **322** connected to the remote server **320**. In some embodiments, remote server **320** is configured to mix audio streams from each remote client device **322** into a single audio stream that is transmitted to local server **302**.

(81) Lastly, at step **414**, the local server **302** may broadcast the remote media data to the one or more local client devices **310**. As previously discussed, by reducing the number of connections from local network **318** to remote server **320** to a single connection, the bandwidth requirements of local network **318** are reduced, which may improve the resiliency of the telehealth session to the quality of local network **318**. In some embodiments, local server **302** also transmits the data received from a first remote server **320** to other remote servers **320**. For example, local server **302** may relay data received from remote server 1 to remote server N.

(82) It will be appreciated that the steps of the method **400** may occur in various orders and may occur simultaneously or near simultaneously. For example, one or more local client devices **310** and remote client devices **322** may transmit media data to local server **302** and remote servers **320**, respectively, at the same time. Furthermore, while discussed with respect to system **300**, one of skill in the art will appreciate that method **400** may also be carried out by system **350** without departing from the scope hereof.

(83) Recording of the Telehealth Session

(84) Embodiments described herein may also provide for improved recordings of telehealth sessions that are resilient to changes in network performance and/or may be synchronized such that the recording reflects the telehealth session at the point of data capture for each recorded data stream, irrespective of network latencies for transmitting data between servers **302**, **320**. Recording telehealth sessions can be useful for instructional use, for example. In some embodiments, multiple recordings of the telehealth session are created. In some embodiments, each video stream is recorded, and a composite recording is created from the individual recordings of the video streams. For example, if the telehealth session comprises four video streams, a recording may be created for each of the four video streams, and a fifth recording may be generated that is a composite of the four video streams. In some embodiments, the composite video is generated as a reproduction of user interface **200** during the telehealth session. For example, if during the telehealth session, a video window **202** is maximized and other video windows **202** are scaled accordingly, the recording may include the adjustment to the user interface **200**.

(85) In some embodiments, a separate recording of each video stream is made that comprises annotations **206**. Thus, if each of the four video streams is annotated on at any point during the telehealth session, four separate recordings of the video streams with the annotations **206** overlaid are made. In some embodiments, a composite annotated recording is generated comprising a composite of the separate annotation recordings. Thus, in the example case where the telehealth session comprises four video streams, ten recordings may be generated: four recordings corresponding to each video stream without annotations, a composite recording of the four recordings without annotations, four recordings corresponding to the annotations made on each of the four video streams, and a composite recording of the four recordings of the annotations. In some embodiments, the session host or another user can define which recordings should be generated. For example, the session host may elect to only generate the non-annotated composite video recording.

(86) In some embodiments, local server **302** generates one or more of the above-described recordings of the telehealth session for later playback. For example, the local server **302** may generate the recording of each video stream (including a corresponding audio stream, in some embodiments), which may be used to generate the composite recording. By generating a recording by local server **302**, it may be guaranteed that media captured by local devices **310**, **312** is saved at the native quality. Thus, a highest quality recording of the medical procedure as captured on site may be preserved. Furthermore, recording at local server **302** ensures that data captured in the operating room is not lost in the event of a loss of Internet connection. For example, without the use of a local server **302**, if devices in the operating room lost connection to a remote server hosting the telehealth session, all media captured during the period of lost connection would be lost from the recording. In some embodiments, the recording made at local server **302** is saved to NAS **306** or in any other memory location.

(87) In some embodiments, both local server **302** and at least one remote server **320** are configured to record the telehealth session as discussed above with respect to FIG. 3B. When multiple remote servers **320** are used, a single remote server **320** may be configured to make the remote recording. In some such embodiments, the remote server is the server with the highest number of connected remote client devices **322**. In other embodiments, each remote server **320** records at least a portion of the session. For example, each remote server **320** may record a video stream received from a connected remote client device **322**. Recordings made by local server **302** are referred to hereinafter as local recordings, and the recordings made by remote servers **320** are referred to hereinafter as remote recordings. In some embodiments, local server **302** and remote server **320** transmit recordings to a recording server **324** for further processing, such as compositing of the individual video streams. In some embodiments, local server **302** and/or remote server **320** carry out the functions of recording server **324**. In some embodiments, a combined recording is generated by combining various portions of the recordings made at each of local server **302** and the at least one remote server **320**. For example, when transmitting telehealth session data from local server **302** to a first remote server **320** and a second remote server **320**, a packet comprising a frame may be lost in transmission to the second remote server **320** while arriving at the first remote server **320**. As such, when combining recordings from the first remote server **320** and the second remote server **320**, the frame lost at the second remote server **320** may be replaced with the corresponding frame at the first remote server **320**.

(88) In some embodiments, the local recording comprises only native feeds from each device operating on the local network **318**. Thus, the local recording may exclude the data feeds received from remote client devices **322**. In some such embodiments, the remote server **320** records all feeds, including the data recorded by the local client devices in local network **318**. Due to the remote servers **320** receiving data from local server **302** over an Internet connection, it is likely that the data from the devices in the local network **318** will be transmitted at a lower quality than the data was captured. For example, if the camera **314** is a 4 k camera, the video feed will likely be downgraded (e.g., to 1080p) when local server **302** transmits the video stream to remote server **320**. Such a scenario is especially likely when the hospital is in an area of relatively poor Internet quality. However, because the data from local devices **310**, **312** in local network **318** are also recorded locally by local server **302**, the native quality of the data can be maintained without degradation. Accordingly, when the local recording and the remote recording are combined to generate the composite recording, the video stream corresponding to media captured by local media devices **312** may be taken from the local recording, and the video stream corresponding to media captured by remote client devices **322** may be taken from the remote recording.

(89) In some embodiments, recording server **324** is configured to generate the composite recording from the local recording(s) and the remote recording(s). The composite recording, in some embodiments, may comprise the highest quality portion of the recording generated from the local recording and the highest quality portion from the remote recording made by one or more remote

servers **320**. For example, the composite recording may be a composite of the video streams from in-OR devices as captured by local server **302** (and optionally saved to NAS **306**) and the video streams transmitted by remote client devices **322** as captured by remote server **320**. When combining the local recording and the remote recording, recording server **324** may synchronize the two recordings. Due to the latency between local server **302** and remote server **320**, the local recording and the remote recording may not be synchronized when transmitted to recording server **324**. For example, camera **314** may stream video to local server **302** at 60 fps, which may be natively stored to NAS **306** and later sent to recording server **324**. However, due to a poor network connection, for example, a remote client device **322** may stream the video to remote server **320** at 30 fps. Accordingly, the recordings may need to be adjusted to account for the differences in frame rate due to latency. In some embodiments, frames from the recording with a higher frame rate are dropped to match a frame rate of a lower frame rate recording. In some embodiments, frames from the lower frame rate recording are repeated to match the higher frame rate recording.

(90) FIG. 5A illustrates an exemplary method **500** for synchronizing the local recording and the remote recording such that the local recording and the remote recording can be combined to generate the composite recording for some embodiments of the present disclosure. Method **500** may begin at step **502**, where a data packet or ping may be transmitted round trip from local server **302** to remote server **320** and back to local server **302** to determine the latency between the servers **302**, **320**. In some embodiments, the data packet is sent periodically throughout the telehealth session. For example, the data packet may be sent about every 200 ms, or at any other interval. When multiple remote servers **320** are used to manage the telehealth session, a data packet may be sent to each remote server **320**. Likewise, if a remote server **320** is kept on standby in the event of a failure of an in-use remote server **320**, a data packet may also be transmitted to the standby remote server **320**. When determining latency between local server **302** and more than one remote server **320**, data packets may be sent to each remote server **320** simultaneously, or data packets may be sent at different intervals for each remote server **320**.

(91) Next, at step **504**, the latency between local server **302** and remote server **320** may be determined based on the round trip time for the data packet. In some embodiments, the latency is determined by assuming that the latency is equivalent for transmitting data from local server **302** to remote server **320** as for transmitting from remote server **320** to local server **302**. Thus, the round trip time may be halved to determine the latency. In some embodiments, a first latency is determined for the time to transmit a ping from local server **302** to remote server **320**, and a second latency is determined for the time to return the ping from remote server **320** to local server **302**. Accordingly, in some embodiments, the time at which the data packet was transmitted by local server **302**, the time at which the data packet was acknowledged at remote server **320**, and the time at which the returned data packet is acknowledged back at local server **302** are evaluated to determine first and second latencies. The latency may be logged or otherwise stored to synchronize the recordings after the telehealth session ends. In some embodiments, remote server **320** initiates the sending of the data packet and logs latency between local server **302** and remote server **320**.

(92) Processing may then proceed to test **506** where it may be determined whether recording is over. Recording may be over when the telehealth session ends or upon receiving an instruction to end recording, such as via user interface **200**. If the recording is not over, processing may return to step **502**, and another data packet may be transmitted to determine the current latency between local server **302** and remote server **320**. As discussed above, the data packet may be transmitted in intervals throughout the telehealth session. For example, the data packet may be transmitted every 200 ms. If recording has ended, processing may proceed to step **508**. In some embodiments, the latency between local server **302** and remote server **320** is logged throughout the telehealth session regardless of whether the session is being recorded.

(93) Synchronization of the local recording and the remote recording may begin at step **508** once recording is complete. In some embodiments, synchronization of the recording takes place after the

telehealth session is complete. At step **508**, an interval of the recording may be evaluated based on the latency. As discussed above, the latency may be logged throughout the telehealth session such that the log may be used after the session for synchronization.

(94) Next, at test **510**, it may be determined whether there was a change in latency as compared to one or more previous intervals. As discussed previously, a change in latency may lead to a change in the copy of the video stream that is simulcasted, which may result in recordings made at differing frame rates. If there is not a change in latency, processing may proceed to step **512**, and the recordings may be synchronized based on the latency. In some embodiments, the remote recording is synchronized to the local recording by adjusting timestamp for the frames in the remote recording based on the latency. For example, if the latency for an interval of the recording containing 12 frames was determined to be 5 ms, timestamps for the 12 frames may be shifted by 5 ms to match the local recording.

(95) If, at test **510**, a change in latency is determined, processing may proceed to test **514**. In some embodiments, the latency must change by above a threshold amount (e.g., 10 ms, 50 ms, etc.) to satisfy test **510**. In some embodiments, a threshold number of intervals must have a change in latency in the same direction (i.e., increase or decrease) to satisfy test **510**. For example, three or more consecutive intervals that have an increase in latency relative to a previous iteration must be present to satisfy test **510**. In some embodiments, the change in latency that satisfies test **510** is the change that results in the video to be streamed at a different frame rate. Other variations of determining whether to adjust the synchronization of the recordings based on a change in latency will be readily apparent to one of skill in the art.

(96) At test **514**, it may be determined whether the change in latency is an increase or a decrease in latency. If the change is an increase, processing may proceed to step **516**. At step **516**, frames may be repeated in the remote recording to account for the increase in latency causing a lower frame rate. By repeating frames in the remote recording, the remote recording may be modified to match the frame rate and be synchronized to the local recording. The recorded audio may be synchronized in a similar manner by increasing a period of quiet within the remote recording to synchronize the audio to the local recording. Alternatively, it is contemplated that frames from the local recording may be dropped to match the frame rate of the remote recording, and the quiet periods in the audio may be shortened. If, at test **514**, it is determined that the latency change is a latency decrease, processing may proceed to step **518**. At step **518**, one or more frames may be dropped from the remote recording to account for the decrease in latency. For example, if the remote recording is at a higher frame rate than the local recording, frames from the remote recording may need to be dropped to match the frame rate of the local recording. Likewise, to synchronize the audio, a period of quiet may be reduced when there is a decrease in latency.

(97) FIG. 5B illustrates a method **550** for synchronizing and combining the remote recording and the local recording by using a reference recording for some embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the remote recording may be used as a reference recording and compared against the local recording to synchronize and/or combine the recordings. Method **550** may begin at step **552** where, for a frame in the local recording, a corresponding frame in the reference recording is identified. The reference frame may be identified using various techniques. For example, computer vision techniques may be used to compare frames from the reference recording with frames from the local recording to find the closest match for each frame. In some embodiments, frames are matched based on timestamps for the recording. For example, it is contemplated that the local recording and the remote recording can be synchronized as discussed above with respect to method **500**. The corresponding reference frame for a local frame may then be determined based on two frames sharing the same or substantially the same timestamp. In some embodiments, each recording server **320** that generates a recording of the telehealth session is analyzed to determine the reference frame. Thus, if a first remote server **320** is missing a reference frame in the recording, the reference frame from a second remote server **320** that is not missing may be utilized.

(98) Next, at test **554**, the local frame may be compared to its corresponding reference frame to determine whether the local frame is of a higher quality than the local frame. In some embodiments, reference frames from multiple remote servers **320** are compared, and the highest quality reference frame is compared against the corresponding frame at local server **302**. In some embodiments, comparing the local frame to the reference frame comprises comparing at least one of a resolution or a frame rate of the two frames. If, at test **554**, it is determined that the local frame is not of a higher quality than the corresponding reference frame, processing may proceed to step **556**, and the reference frame is kept in the recording. For example, if neither the resolution or the frame rate of the local recording is higher than that of the corresponding reference frame, the local frame may be determined to be of lower quality than the reference frame, and the reference frame is kept in the recording. This may be the case where the frames are being compared for a recording of a video stream originating from a remote client device **322**, for example, as the quality of the video stream may degrade when transmitting from remote server **320** to local server **302** such that remote server **320** has the highest quality recording of the video stream. Processing may then proceed back to step **552** to process the next frame in the recording.

(99) If, at test **554**, it is determined that the local recording is of a higher quality of the reference recording, processing may proceed to step **558**, and the local frame may replace the reference frame. In some embodiments, if either the resolution or the frame rate is higher in the local frame than the reference frame, it may be determined that the local frame is higher quality than the reference frame. Processing may then proceed back to step **552** to evaluate the next frame. It will be appreciated that method **550** may be performed using the local recording as the reference recording.

(100) When replacing frames as described above with respect to FIG. 5B, any annotations **206** present in the recording may need to be resynchronized. In some embodiments, if the local frame that is replacing a reference frame is a repeated frame (e.g., when inserted into the recording to account for an increase in latency), the annotation may not be added until a non-repeated frame is detected. Once a non-repeated frame is detected, the annotation **206** may be overlaid on or written into the recording. In some embodiments, the aspect ratio of an annotation **206** is adjusted to scale the annotation **206** for the recording. The resolution may also be upsampled or downsampled to match the resolution of the **206** to the resolution of the frame.

(101) In some embodiments, the composite recording is synchronized such that each data feed in the recording is played to match the time of data capture for each feed. That is, the recording for each data feed may be time-shifted in the composite recording based on the latency for each data feed during the recording of the telehealth session. For example, where the latency for video captured in hospital **250** to be displayed on remote client devices **322** is 15 ms, the recording of the video feed the video captured in hospital **250** may be shifted by 15 ms. This, therefore, allows the synchronized recording to comprise a recording in which the events in the hospital **250** and the reaction to said events by a remote user operating remote client device **322** are synchronized and displayed at the same time in the recording. It will be appreciated that generally any type of data that is transmitted recorded during the telehealth session may be synchronized in accordance with the present teachings. As another example, a telehealth session may include the use of generated 3D data. The 3D data may be a rendering of a patient's organ, LIDAR data, point cloud data, or the like, that may be useful in a telesurgery application. A local client device **310** may be configured to generate this 3D data, for example, and the latency between the local client device **310** transmitting the 3D data to local server **302** (or the latency for the data to reach remote client devices **322**, for example) may be used to generate the synchronized recording.

(102) FIG. 6 illustrates an exemplary method **600** for monitoring latencies of devices in telehealth sessions and generating a synchronized recording based on the latencies in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. A plurality of latencies may be monitored during the telehealth session, including both a plurality of the same latency for the duration or portion of the

telehealth session (e.g., monitoring the latency between local server **302** and remote server **320** during the telehealth session), along with a plurality of latency types (e.g., latency for each of a video feed, an audio feed, and sensor feedback from a surgical device). As previously discussed, a combined recording of the telehealth session may be generated that comprises both local and remote recordings of data generated during the telehealth session. The combined recording may be rendered as a replica of the user interface **200** shown during the telehealth session and/or the combined recording may allow for individual data feeds to be selectively viewed. For example, within a user interface for viewing the combined recording, a video feed may be selected from the composite view to view only the selected video feed. The combined recording may be synchronized such that each recorded data feed is synchronized to the point of data capture to obviate discrepancies in events participant was reacting to due to latency. Syncing the recordings may also enable the video feed to exactly match the time at which telemetry data was captured. For example, if a heartbeat sensor generates log emissions at constant intervals, a video recording of the patient wearing the heartbeat sensor may be synchronized to the emission of the logs, removing any latency from capturing the video and transmitting the video to local server **302**.

(103) Method **600** may begin at step **602** where latencies for devices participating in the telehealth session are monitored. In some embodiments, a latency is monitored for each device that transmits data to another device that is also participating in the telehealth session. In some embodiments, the latency is monitored for a single hop (e.g., from telesurgery device **262** to local server **256**), for multiple hops (e.g., from telesurgery device **262** to local server **256** and then to a remote server), or a combination thereof. For local devices **310**, **312**, the latency may be tracked between the devices **310**, **312** and local server **302**. In some embodiments, local devices **310**, **312** transmit a message to each device in local network **318** that is also returned to the sending device **310**, **312**. Accordingly, when the sending device receives the message back (i.e., from local server **302**), the latency between the sending device and local server **302** may be determined based on when the message was transmitted by the sending device and when the message was received back at the sending device. For example, the sending local media device **312** may be a telesurgery device such as a robotic scalpel. The robotic scalpel may have a transceiver or the like to transmit a message to the message broker with haptic sensor data that includes a timestamp, which may be logged such that the latency between the local media device **312** and local message broker **308a** may be determined. Remote devices **322** may likewise have their latency monitored by remote server **320** by transmissions of messages (e.g., data packets, echo pings, etc.) that are timestamped, thereby enabling latency to be determined based on the time stamps. Generally, any method of monitoring latency for any device participating in the telehealth session (e.g., local client devices **310**, local media devices **312**, remote client devices, servers **302**, **320**, telemetry devices, etc.) is within the scope hereof.

(104) At optional step **604**, corrective action may be taken in response to determining that a latency for a device has increased above a threshold. In some embodiments, the corrective action is configured to mitigate unsafe telehealth operations due to high latencies for device(s) in the telehealth session. For example, if a remote user operating remote client device **322** is remotely controlling a telesurgery device and the remote client device **322** experiences increased latency, the remote user may be viewing the surgical operation at a delay and instructions for controlling the telesurgery device may be based on old audio/video data of the telesurgery operation that are no longer reflective of the current state of the telesurgery. Accordingly, the corrective action may be used to prevent the instructions generated by the remote user from being carried out by the surgery device. In some embodiments, the corrective action comprises a notification generated by a server **302**, **320** and transmitted to the remote client devices **322**. In some embodiments, each device monitors the device's own latency and accordingly may broadcast a message to one or more other devices or servers of the latency increase.

(105) Processing may proceed to step **606** where a combined recording of the telehealth session is

generated. The combined recording may comprise the remote recording(s) and the local recording(s) received from each device **310**, **312**, **322** as previously discussed with respect to FIGS. 5A-5B.

(106) Thereafter, at step **608**, the combined recording may be synchronized based on the latencies monitored during the telehealth session. The combined recording may be synchronized such that each data feed is played in the recording at a time corresponding to the actual time of data captured as opposed to when the data was streamed as part of the telehealth session. Thus, for example, the local recordings of media captured in hospital **250** may have a latency of 15 ms between the media being captured, local server **302** applying any obscurations or other processing, local server **302** transmitting the media to remote server **320**, and remote server **320** forwarding the data to the remote client devices **322**. Accordingly, when generating the synchronized recording, the local recording may be displayed 15 ms earlier in the synchronized recording to reflect when the local media data was actually captured.

(107) Next, at test **610**, it may be determined whether the recordings have different frame rates. As previously discussed, the recordings may have different frame rates due to network latency, among other factors. For example, local server **302** may record local media data at a high frame rate (e.g., 30 fps), while remote client devices **322** may transmit data to remote server **320** at a lower frame rate (e.g., 15 fps) due to latency between remote server **320** and remote client devices **322**. If, at test **610**, it is determined that the recordings do not have different frame rates, method **600** may end **612**.

(108) If, at test **610**, it is determined that the recordings do have different frame rates, processing may proceed to step **614**, where the recordings may be adjusted to equalize the frame rates. In some embodiments, step **614** is substantially similar to step **516** or step **518** discussed above, where frames may be repeated and audio may be adjusted to account for increases in latency. For example, for a remote recording having a frame rate of 15 fps, each frame may be repeated once to double frame rate to 30 fps to match that of a local recording having a frame rate of 30 fps. In some embodiments, frame averaging techniques are employed to adjust the frame rate of a data stream in a recording.

(109) While embodiments herein have been discussed with respect to telehealth sessions, it will be appreciated that the embodiments are not limited to telehealth. For example, it is contemplated that the above-described architecture may be useful in any scenario in which data transmitted in a video conference needs to be secured. As another example, if a video conference is held in a location where a portion of the participants are in a region with strong local Internet connectivity and a poor international connectivity and a portion of participants are located internationally, the use of an edge video server may be useful to reduce the network requirements of the local participants.

(110) Although the present disclosure has been described with reference to the embodiments illustrated in the attached drawing figures, it is noted that equivalents may be employed and substitutions made herein without departing from the scope of the present disclosure as recited in the claims.

Claims

1. A hybrid media distribution system for a telehealth session, comprising: a local server operating on a local network, the local server disposed in a location associated with a patient; at least one local media device connected to the local network and configured to capture local media of the telehealth session; and at least one remote server operating on a remote network, the at least one remote server not disposed in the location associated with the patient, wherein the local server comprises at least one local server processor configured to execute computer-executable instructions to: receive the local media from the at least one local media device; broadcast the local media to the at least one remote server; and generate a first video recording comprising the local

media captured by the at least one local media device, wherein the local media comprises at least one first video stream; wherein the at least one remote server comprises at least one remote server processor configured to execute further computer-executable instructions to: receive the local media from the local network; broadcast the local media to at least one remote participant; generate a second video recording comprising telehealth session data received from the at least one remote participant, wherein the telehealth session data comprises at least one second video stream; log a first plurality of latencies between the local server and the at least one remote server; log a second plurality of latencies between the at least one remote server and the at least one remote participant; and generate a synchronized recording of the telehealth session based on the first video recording, the second video recording, the first plurality of latencies, and the second plurality of latencies, wherein the synchronized recording includes the at least one first video stream from the first video recording and the at least one second video stream from the second video recording, and wherein the synchronized recording is synchronized to a time of data capture of the at least one first video stream by shifting in time the at least one second video stream based on at least one of the second plurality of latencies.

2. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 1, wherein logging the first plurality of latencies comprises determining each latency of the first plurality of latencies based on a data packet sent between the local server and the at least one remote server.

3. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 1, wherein the at least one local server processor is further configured to: apply at least one obscuration to the at least one first video stream prior to transmitting the local media to the at least one remote server.

4. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 3, wherein each of the first plurality of latencies is a combined latency comprising a network latency between the local server and the at least one remote server and a computational latency associated with applying the at least one obscuration to the local media.

5. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 1, wherein the first plurality of latencies comprises a plurality of video latencies associated with the at least one first video stream transmitted from the local server to the at least one remote server and a plurality of audio latencies associated with audio data transmitted from the local server to the at least one remote server.

6. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 1, wherein the at least one local media device comprises a telesurgery device, wherein the at least one remote participant controls remote operation of the telesurgery device.

7. The hybrid media distribution system of claim 6, wherein at least one of the local server or the at least one remote server is further configured to: restrict control of the remote operation of the telesurgery device in response to an increase in the second plurality of latencies.

8. One or more non-transitory computer-readable media storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by at least one processor, perform a method of hybrid media distribution for telehealth sessions, comprising: receiving, at a local server, local media data of a telehealth session from at least one local media device connected to the local server, wherein the local server is disposed in a first location associated with a patient; transmitting, by the local server, the local media data to at least one remote server operating on a remote network, the at least one remote server not disposed in the first location associated with the patient; generating a native video recording of the local media data on the local server, wherein the local media data comprises at least one first video stream; responsive to receiving the local media data at the at least one remote server, broadcasting the local media data to one or more remote participants connected to the at least one remote server; receiving, at the at least one remote server, telehealth session data from a remote participant from the one or more remote participants; generating a remote video recording of the telehealth session data on the at least one remote server, wherein the telehealth session data comprises at least one second video stream; logging a first plurality of latencies between the local server and the at least one remote server; logging a second plurality of latencies between the at

least one remote server and the one or more remote participants; and generating a synchronized recording of the telehealth session based on the native video recording, the remote video recording, the first plurality of latencies, and the second plurality of latencies, wherein the synchronized recording includes the at least one first video stream from the native video recording and the at least one second video stream from the remote video recording, and wherein the synchronized recording is synchronized to a time of data capture of the at least one first video stream by shifting in time the at least one second video stream based on at least one of the second plurality of latencies.

9. The media of claim 8, the method further comprising: transmitting the telehealth session data from the at least one remote server to the local server; and broadcasting the telehealth session data from the local server to at least one local client device connected to the local server.

10. The media of claim 8, wherein generating the synchronized recording comprises adjusting a remote video stream associated with the remote video recording based on the second plurality of latencies.

11. The media of claim 8, the method further comprising: detecting an increase in the second plurality of latencies; and transmitting, by the local server, a notification indicative of the increase in the second plurality of latencies to the one or more remote participants.

12. The media of claim 8, wherein the method further comprises: prior to transmitting the local media data to the at least one remote server, applying, by the local server, an obscuration to at least a portion of the at least one first video stream.

13. The media of claim 12, the method further comprising: logging a plurality of computational latencies; and responsive to detecting an increase in the plurality of computational latencies, changing an obscuring method for obscuring the portion of the at least one first video stream.

14. A method for hybrid media distribution for a telehealth session, comprising: receiving, at a local server operating on a hospital network, local media data of an operation being performed on a patient within a hospital associated with the hospital network; transmitting the local media data to a remote server that is not disposed in the hospital; responsive to receiving the local media data at the remote server, broadcasting, by the remote server, the local media data to a remote participant; generating, on the local server, a first recording comprising the local media data, wherein the local media data comprises at least one first video stream; receiving remote telehealth session data from the remote participant at the remote server; transmitting the remote telehealth session data to the local server; generating, on the remote server, a second recording comprising the remote telehealth session data, wherein the remote telehealth session data comprises at least one second video stream; and generating a combined recording of the telehealth session based on the first recording and the second recording; and synchronizing the combined recording by adjusting at least one of the first recording or the second recording based on a plurality of network latencies logged during the telehealth session, wherein the combined recording includes the at least one first video stream from the first recording and the at least one second video stream from the second recording, and wherein the combined recording is synchronized to a time of data capture of the at least one first video stream by shifting in time the at least one second video stream based on at least one of the plurality of network latencies.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the first recording comprises a first frame rate higher than a second frame rate of the second recording.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein synchronizing the combined recording further comprises repeating frames from the second recording such that the second frame rate is increased to be equal to the first frame rate.

17. The method of claim 14, wherein the method further comprises: prior to transmitting the local media data to the remote server, applying, by the local server, an obscuration to the at least one first video stream.

18. The method of claim 14, further comprising: generating a third recording comprising data

captured by a telesurgery device, logging a third plurality of latencies associated with a plurality of log messages generated by the telesurgery device and transmitted to the local server, wherein the combined recording further comprises the third recording, and wherein synchronizing the combined recording is further based on the third plurality of latencies.

19. The method of claim 14, wherein the local media data comprises at least one of audio data, video data, telestration data, telemetry data, or telesurgery data.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein at least one of the local server or the remote server is configured to take a corrective action in response to an increase in a latency associated with the telesurgery data.
